Lesson 17 material: Reading Profiles 1: An Employee, Reynolds, Student Spotlights

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 2: Getting to Know You

1.1: Video: Amazon Employee Profile

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Analyzing a Profile Video

Watch the employee profile video and answer the questions below. Then discuss with your instructor and classmates.

Video: https://youtu.be/loyvKtwXqeA

- Where would you expect to see this video? (**genre)**
  - On Instagram
  - On a dating website
  - On a college website
  - On a company website
- Who is the **audience** for this video? Choose all that apply.
  - The company Amazon
  - The general public
  - John's friends and family
  - A company that needs employees
- What is the **purpose** of this video? Choose all that apply.
  - To help John find a new job
  - To explain step by step how to get hired at Amazon
  - To show how happy an employee is working for Amazon
  - To make the company feel more personal by introducing some of its employees
- What elements of the reading helped you decide the answers to the questions above? Choose all that apply.
  - The topic
  - The format
  - The register (formal or informal language)
  - The pictures

- The vocabulary
- Other

This is a video of an employee profile. From watching this video, what are some of the features of a profile? Choose the best answer to each question.

- A profile is:
  - About one person
  - About many people
- A profile is:
  - Short
  - Long
- A profile has:
  - A person's whole life history
  - A few facts about the person's history
- A profile focuses on:
  - One part of a person's life, such as work, school, a hobby, or a special interest
  - Everything that is important to that person
- A profile has:
  - A negative tone
  - A positive tone
- A profile is about:
  - Someone famous
  - Anyone

An answer key is attached, but answers may vary.

Contributed by Michele Weaver, Grossmont College

1.2: Reading: Profile Reynolds

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Pre-reading Activity

Discuss or write about the questions below.

- Have you ever visited a national park in the U.S.? Look at the map below for the locations of national parks. Identify Yosemite, Shenandoah, and the Grand Canyon National Parks on the map.
- What is a park ranger? What kind of work does a park ranger do?

(Picture: File:NationalParks.forwiki.pdf)

Figure: The United States' National Parks

Vocabulary Preview

Put a check next to the words you know. Then, ask a classmate or your instructor to explain the words you do not know, or look them up.

- Award
- Recipient
- Develop
- Lead through example
- Inspire
- Mentor
- Challenge
- Journey
- Public service

Profile Reading

Read the profile below. Then answer the questions to check your understanding.

Congratulations to the 2015 recipient of the Harry Yount National Park Ranger Award!

(Picture: Leslie Reynolds)

Figure: Leslie Reynolds, Chief Ranger, Cape Cod National Seashore, Massachusetts

After a visit to the Grand Canyon, Leslie Reynolds was hooked. Her love of national parks would take her on an incredible **journey** of **public service** and adventures in parks across the country.

Beginning as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park, Reynolds went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor,

investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents.

Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped **develop** the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen.

As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to **inspire** the new generation of park rangers and **lead through example.**

"I consider myself very fortunate to have chosen a career that is **rewarding**, that I am proud of, and one that continues to **challenge** me every day," said Reynolds. "My **inspiration** comes mostly from the rangers of the National Park Service with whom I have had the great honor of working with for the past twenty years. One of the most **rewarding** aspects of my profession is **developing** and **mentoring** others and watching them succeed, grow, and contribute to the ranger profession."

Comprehension and Rhetorical Analysis

After reading the profile, answer the questions below.

- Who is the profile about?
- What organization does she work for?
- Where does she work now?
- What is her job title now?
- Where did she work in the past?
- What job titles did she have in the past?
- What programs and teams did she start or serve?

Answer the questions below with keywords from the article.

- What is the name of the award that Leslie Reynolds received?
- What organization gave her the award?
- The final paragraph of this article has quotation marks. Who is speaking in this paragraph?
- What are at least three professional accomplishments of Leslie Reynolds?
- What inspires Leslie Reynolds, in her own words?

Choose the option that best answers the question.

- What is the purpose of this article?
  - To inform readers of the services at the park
  - To convince readers that Leslie Reynolds is an excellent employee
  - To persuade readers to visit a national park
  - To educate readers about the dangers at the park

Choose all possible answers. Discuss with your classmates and add one reason.

- What are some reasons organizations give awards?
  - To motivate employees to do a good job
  - To inform employees and visitors of the expectations for a good employee
  - To convince customers/visitors that the organization has good employees
  - To make employees feel valuable

Choose the word that best completes the sentence.

- The article mostly has information about Leslie Reynolds' _____ life.
  - Professional
  - Personal

Fill in the blank.

- Leslie Reynolds has worked for the National Park Service for _____ years

Vocabulary Activities

Match the word/phrase with its definition.

Word/Phrase Bank

- Recipient (n)
- Award (n)
- Develop (v)
- Inspire (v)
- Lead through example (phrase)
- Rewarding (adj)
- Challenge (v)
- Mentor (v)
- Journey (n)
- Public service (noun phrase)

Definitions

- To create or produce especially by deliberate effort over time
- Something suggesting travel from one place to another
- An activity or job paid for by the government and meant to help everyone
- To advise or train someone younger or less experienced
- To act in a way that shows others how to act
- A person or thing that receives something
- A prize in honor of an achievement
- To present a task that requires great effort
- Providing satisfaction

- To make someone feel that they want to do something and can do it

Fill in the blanks below with the vocabulary words from the word/phrase bank above. Use the dictionary if you need it.

- In the 1980's, my family took a long _____ by plane from the U.S. to Mauritius, where I learned about a new culture.
- People who work with computers always _____ new programs to help their customers.
- Learning a new language _____ us in ways we never imagined. It's hard!
- Instead of finding a job at a big corporation, I decided to find a job with the government in _____.
- A good role model like Martin Luther King, Jr or Malala Yousifzai can _____ people to make changes in the world around them.
- She enjoys her job because it's _____. Every day she goes home feeling satisfied.
- The _____ of the Oscar often cry when they give their speeches on stage.
- The Oscar is the highest _____ for movies, and the Tony is the highest _____ (same word) for theater.
- If you want your children to do the right thing, you must _____. That means you have to be a good role model.
- He has a good boss. His boss _____ him and helps him learn how to do his job well.

Words and phrases often occur in the language together. Just like "peanut butter and jelly," some words have collocations, that is, other words that follow or precede them often. The vocabulary words in the word/phrases bank have common collocations, shown below.

- Recipient of
- Award to
- Develop a program/business/system/method
- Inspire (someone) to do (something)
- Rewarding job/task/career/occupation/work/profession
- Challenge (someone) to do (something)
- Mentor (someone)
- Journey to/through/from

Writing activity

Choose five vocabulary words above and write a short paragraph describing a job or career that was or will be rewarding for you.

1.3: Reading: Student Spotlights

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Read the Student Profiles. Then answer the questions to check your understanding.

Student Profile #1

Student Spotlight--Meet Jennifer Moy

Posted on November 20, 2019 by Christopher Larson

Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan. Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth, she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.

Figure: Jennifer Moy

Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year, her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library and has helped make them happen.

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday." We're looking forward to that day, Jennifer!

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Student Profile #2

Student Spotlight--Shivani Mishra

Posted on December 11, 2019 by Christopher Larson

For December’s Student Spotlight we present Shivani Mishra! Shivani grew up on Long Island where she attended Half Hollow Hills High School. In 2018 she was inducted into the National Honor Society

and the National French Honor Society, and is a three-time winner of the National French Exam Contest. She also happens to be a certified Kenpō Martial Arts black belt… so don't mess with her!

Inspired by her volunteer experience in the hospital and as an emergency medical technician Shivani knew she wanted to learn medicine but when she started her first semester at Stony Brook she had no idea what to major in. Despite the pressure to declare her major she stayed focused on her pre-medicine courses (general chemistry, classical physics, calculus) until she discovered an area of study that she liked

"Physics was especially appealing to me. On Saturdays and Sundays, I enjoyed the quiet and peaceful Math/Physics Library to work on my homework or to peruse the collections. I enjoyed spending my time at the physics library so much that I decided to apply as a student library assistant at the end of the semester."

– Shivani Mishra

Figure: Shivani Mishra

As a student employee, Shivani learned new skills using the library's vast print and online resources, and building connections with other students and faculty. Eventually, Shivani declared her major in physics. She wants to delve into medicine and physics, and integrate her biomedical research interests with her passion for physics. We wish her the best in all of her academic pursuits. Of course, we're proud to have her on board with us while she does.

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Comprehension and Rhetorical Analysis

After reading the two profiles above, answer the questions below.

- Who is the author of both profiles?
- What are the titles and dates of publication for each profile?
- What institution published these student spotlights? Make a guess. How did you find the answer to this question?
- Who is the audience for these profiles? Choose all that apply.
  - People who work at Stony Brook University
  - Students who attend Stony Brook University
  - People who want to attend Stony Brook University in the future
  - Students at other universities

Fill out the chart below for both profiles.

Profile #1	Profile #2
Name of student	
Where she grew up	
High school	
Current major	

Future plans
Where she works now

Christopher Larson is the author of both of these profiles. In order to write these profiles, he needed to interview Jennifer Moy and Shivani Mishra. In other words, he needed to ask them questions to find out more about them. Practice composing questions about the readings by completing the activity below.

Read the first paragraph of both profiles again. What questions did the Christopher Larson ask both students? One question has been written below as an example. Write two more questions.

- *Where did you go to high school?*

Read the second paragraph of Spotlight#1 below. Which question did the interviewer ask Jennifer? Choose the best **open-ended** question. Open-ended questions begin with a "wh" question word and allow for a long answer.

Spotlight #1: *When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth, she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.*

1. Where did you decide to go to college?
2. Where is your new home?
3. Why did you decide to attend Stony Brook University?
4. Did you decide to attend Stony Brook University?

Read the second paragraph of Spotlight#2 below. What question do you think the iChristopher Larson asked Shivani? Write an **open-ended** question.

Spotlight #2: *Inspired by her volunteer experience in the hospital and as an emergency medical technician Shivani knew she wanted to learn medicine but when she started her first semester at Stony Brook she had no idea what to major in. Despite the pressure to declare her major she stayed focused on her pre-medicine courses (general chemistry, classical physics, calculus) until she discovered an area of study that she liked.*

Most profiles use quotations. Read the excerpt below. It contains a quotation. A quotation is a set of words inside quotation marks. It looks like this: "word word word." Who said the words in the quotation below?

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: ***"I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday."***

Note about words used in the U.S. educational system

Students in a four-year program such as high school or university may be identified by the year they are completing in the program.

- First year--***freshman***
- Second year--***sophomore***
- Third year--***junior***
- Fourth year--***senior***

Students earning their associate's or bachelor's degree are called ***undergraduate*** students.

Students earning a degree after their bachelor's degree are called ***graduate*** students.

Common degrees offered in U.S. colleges and universities are ***associate's*** (2-year), ***bachelor's*** (4-year), ***master's*** (bachelor's plus 2 years), and ***doctorate*** (master's plus a varying number of years)

vocabulary: despite

Despite is a contrast signal word that means "even though" or "in spite of."

We use "despite" to say the situation or person was not affected by something.

"Despite" is used before a noun phrase.

Example: Despite my head cold, I went to work today (I went to work even though I had a head cold).

Example: Despite the difficulty of the final exam, the students passed the class (the students passed the class even though the final exam was difficult).

vocabulary words and phrases related to college/university

- Dormitory
- Freshman
- Sophomore
- Junior
- Senior
- Major
- Declare a major
- Graduate (n) (v)
- Graduation
- Associate's, bachelor's, master's degree
- Specialize
- Semester
- Program

vocabulary words and phrases for careers and education

- Inspire
- Motivate
- On board

- Volunteer (n) (v)
- Intern
- Pursue (v)
- Pursuit (n)
- Adventure
- In (high, low) demand
- Resource
- Travel

idioms and signal words

- By a long shot
- Don't mess with
- Despite

majors and specializations

- Photography
- Geography
- Architecture
- Physics

Links on the original page

- Web page (library.stonybrook.edu): https://library.stonybrook.edu/2019/11/20/student-spotlight-meet-jennifer-moy/n
- Web page (library.stonybrook.edu): https://library.stonybrook.edu/2019/12/11/student-spotlight-shivani-mishra/